County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, March 23, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/378954

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:00 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik - Virtual
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham - @ 6:05 PM
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson - Virtual
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation

Council Member Reitz led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. APPROVAL OF AGENDA

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve the agenda.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Council Member McElynn, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to amend the agenda to add a discussion item to discuss going forward hiring a professional organization to assist us with materials relating to both the education and advocacy of the infrastructure referendum that is tentatively scheduled for the ballot in November, and it will be item 11.b.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion to amend passed 10:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve the agenda as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The main motion passed 10:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Dawson, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve the minutes from Caucus and Council on March 9, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

6. Proclamation

Council Member Bartholomew presented a proclamation recognizing March as Disabilities and Special Needs Month.

7. Administrator's Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/378954

8. Public Comment Period

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full comments.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/378954

9. Liaison and Committee Reports

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/378954

10. Approval of Consent Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the consent agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

CONSENT AGENDA

a. Items Originating from the Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee

1. Approval of a contract amendment to Fraser Construction for the construction portion of the Sun City Fire/EMS Station 39 ($5,348,446)

END OF CONSENT AGENDA

11. Agenda Items

a. Consideration of options to fund USCB's Convocation Center
Finance, Administration, & Economic Development Committee voted to deny approval - 4:4
(FISCAL IMPACT: It will be dependent on which option the Council chooses.) - Pinky Harriott, CGFO
Chief Financial Officer

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member McElynn to adopt option 4.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 6:5.

b. Discussion of hiring a professional organization to assist with materials related to both the education and advocacy of the Infrastructure Referendum that is tentatively scheduled for the ballot in November.

Council directed Administration to come up with some suggestions on how we can proceed with hiring a professional organization to assist with the education of the item and have those suggestions by the end of the month.

12. Ordinances for Third Reading

a. 2026/07: An ordinance amending the Zoning map for 5 acres (R300 016 000 0063 0000, R300 016 000 0064 0000, R300 016 000 0065 0000) from T3HN to T4VC.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on February 3, 2026 - 6:0:1
The vote at First Reading on February 23, 2026 - 8:2:1
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on March 9, 2026 - 8:2:1
At their November 3, 2025 meeting, the Planning Commission voted 8-0 recommending approval of the rezoning.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member McElynn to approve third reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2056/07.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member Cunningham. The motion passed 9:1:1

*Council Member Glover recused himself

13. Ordinances for Second Reading

a. 2026/06: An Ordinance adding a new Section 54-8 to the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances so as to prohibit and make unlawful the discharge of firearms in certain unincorporated areas of the county, to provide the penalty pertaining to such violations, and to provide certain exceptions and

limitations thereto.

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on February 3, 2026 - 6:2
The vote at First Reading on February 23, 2026 - 7:4
Public Hearing was held on March 9, 2026
The vote to postpone Second Reading until the March 23, 2026 County Council Meeting - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Reitz to remand it back to the Community Services and Public Safety Committee for revisions to be made to the Ordinance and be brought back to either the April or May meeting.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

14. Ordinances for First Reading:

a. 2026/08: An ordinance to amend Ordinance 2023/26 to reallocate funds previously appropriated for Daufuskie Island Ferry embarkation points to Sun City Joint Fire/EMS Station (Station #39).

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on March 16, 2026 - 8:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve first reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/08.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

b. 2026/09: An Ordinance to reallocate the funds from the 2025 Series GO Bond for Passive Parks projects. **(FISCAL IMPACT: There is no fiscal impact. The same dollar amount is going from two projects to four projects of $5,940,912.)** - Pinky Harriott, CGFO - Chief Financial Officer Stefanie Nagid- Land Preservation Director

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to Approve.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Howard, Council Member Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

15. Resolutions

a. 2026/09: A Resolution authorizing acceptance of an adjusted compensation plan for public safety pay bands 400 through 414 - detention center.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Dawson, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/09.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

b. 2026/10: A Resolution ratifying the findings and recommendations of the supplemental compensation and classification study for an Elected Office as part of the Beaufort County Employee Classification and Compensation Plan.
This item is being brought straight to council.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/10.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

16. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

Sarah W. Brock

_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: April 13, 2026